

St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) Board Policy Document

Introduction

This policy document outlines the governance framework for St Theresa's School (Plimmerton), a state-integrated Catholic primary school for Years 1-6. It is designed to provide clear guidance for the school board in fulfilling its responsibilities to the school community, upholding the school's Catholic character, and ensuring the best possible outcomes for all students.

The document is structured around four main policy areas: Impact Policies, Board-Management Relationship Policies, Operational Expectation Policies, and Governance Culture Policies. These policies collectively define the board's role, its relationship with the principal, operational boundaries, and governance processes.

This framework is based on the Policy Governance model and adapted to meet the specific needs and context of St Theresa's School. It reflects the school's mission "To live, learn and love with Jesus, being the best we can be," and incorporates the SPARK values (Self-control, Positivity, Aroha, Respect, Kindness) that are central to the school's ethos.

The policies in this document are designed to work together as a cohesive suite, providing a comprehensive approach to school governance that balances strategic leadership with operational flexibility. They aim to focus the board's role on governance and the principal's role on leading and managing the school, while ensuring accountability to the school community, the Crown, and the Catholic Church.

This document should be regularly reviewed and updated to ensure it remains relevant and effective in guiding the governance of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton).

Definitions

Board: The school board of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton)

Principal: The chief executive of the school, responsible for its day-to-day management

Impact Policies: Policies that define the desired results for students and the school's purpose

Operational Expectation Policies: Policies that set boundaries and expectations for school operations

Governance Culture Policies: Policies that describe how the board will conduct itself and carry out its duties

Board-Management Relationship Policies: Policies that outline the relationship between the board and the principal

SPARK values: Self-control, Positivity, Aroha, Respect, Kindness - the core values of St Theresa's School

Te Tiriti o Waitangi: The Treaty of Waitangi, New Zealand's founding document

Kāhui Ako: Community of Learning, a group of education and training providers working together to help learners achieve their full potential

Catholic character: The special character of St Theresa's School as a Catholic educational institution

Crown: The government of New Zealand

PCBU: Person Conducting a Business or Undertaking, a key concept in New Zealand health and safety legislation

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Impact Policies

1 Global Impact Policy

Each student will be enabled to develop their personality, talents and abilities to fullest potential, and participate as responsible, informed, active and critical citizens of the local, national and global communities in which they live - in a learning community characterised by respect for everyone's rights and Te Tiriti o Waitangi.

1.1 Fulfilment of Educational Potential

At St Theresa's School (Plimmerton), each student will develop, to a level suitable for a successful transition to the next stage of their lives:

- a) Resilience, determination, confidence, and creative and critical thinking, in alignment with our SPARK values (Self-control, Positivity, Aroha, Respect, Kindness).
- b) Good social skills and the ability to form good relationships, emphasising gospel values including manaakitanga and whanaungatanga.
- c) Participation in community life and fulfilment of civic and social responsibilities, reflecting our mission "To live, learn and love with Jesus, being the best we can be."
- d) Preparedness for future learning and life experiences as autonomous learners within a holistic framework.
- e) Appreciation of the importance of:
 - i. The inclusion of different groups and persons with different personal characteristics.
 - ii. Diversity, cultural knowledge, identity, and the different official languages, with particular emphasis on Māori and Samoan cultures represented in our school community.
 - iii. Te Tiriti o Waitangi and te reo Māori, recognising our commitment to bicultural partnership.
- f) Progress and achievement in line with the National Education and Learning Priorities (NELP).

The school will regularly monitor and report on student progress to ensure each student is fulfilling their educational potential.

For students in Year 7 and above, the school will provide appropriate career education and guidance.

1.2 Experience of being in a Learning Community

At St Theresa's School (Plimmerton):

- a) All members of the learning community value learning and human rights and support the learning and rights of others.
- b) Each student experiences respect for their rights to a suitable education, physical and emotional safety, non-discrimination, and other rights.
- c) Students develop as autonomous learners within a supportive, Christ-centred environment that fosters the SPARK values.
- d) The school actively participates in and contributes to the Northern Porirua Kāhui AkolCommunity of Learning, enhancing educational opportunities and outcomes for all students.

1.3 Respect for Te Tiriti o Waitangi

Students at St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) acknowledge, understand and respect:

- a) New Zealand's bicultural heritage and the place of Te Tiriti as the founding document in the constitution.
- b) Governance of New Zealand under the Crown.
- c) Māori rights and interests under Article 2.
- d) Citizenship equality under Article 3.

e) The importance of te reo Māori and tikanga Māori in our school culture and curriculum, reflecting our commitment to partnership with local iwi and the Māori community.

f) The role of Te Tiriti o Waitangi in shaping a just and equitable society for all New Zealanders.

Board-Management Relationship Policies

2. Global Board-Management Relationship Policy

A board is responsible for the governance of the school, including setting the policies by which the school is to be controlled and managed. Only officially passed motions of the board are binding on the principal.

2.1 Board authority

2.1.1 Rests with the Board

Decisions or instructions of individual board members, officers, or committees are not binding on the principal except in rare instances when the board has specifically authorised such exercise of authority.

2.1.2 Requests of Principal need authorisation of the board

In the case of board members or committees requesting information or assistance without board authorisation, the principal can refuse such requests that require, in the principal's opinion, a material amount of staff time or funds, or are disruptive.

2.2 Accountability of the Principal

The principal is the board's only link to the operation of the school, so that all authority and accountability of staff is through the principal.

2.2.1 Exclusively

The board will never give instructions to persons who report directly or indirectly to the principal.

2.2.2 Only Principal manages staff

The board will not manage, either formally or informally, any staff other than the principal.

2.2.3 The principal is accountable for school performance

The board will view principal performance as identical to school performance, in so far as it is reasonable to do so, so that school accomplishment of board-stated Impacts and within operational expectations will be viewed as successful principal performance.

2.3 Delegation to the Principal

The board will instruct the principal through written policies that prescribe the organisational Impacts to be achieved, broad operational expectations and organisational situations and actions to be avoided, allowing the principal to use any reasonable interpretation of these policies.

2.3.1 Delegation to the Principal for achieving Impacts

Impact policies will be developed by the board instructing the principal to achieve specified results, for all students, within resources available to the board.

2.3.2 Delegations to the Principal will include delegations

The board's Operational Expectation policies will describe those practices, activities, decisions, and circumstances that would be unacceptable to the board even if they were to be effective. Outside of these operational expectations the principal has freedom to use their discretion in exercising their delegations.

2.3.3 Reasonable Interpretation

As long as the principal uses any reasonable interpretation of the board's Impact and Operational Expectation policies, the principal is authorised to establish all further policies, make all decisions, take all actions, establish all practices, and pursue all activities. Such decisions of the principal shall have full force and authority as if decided by the board.

2.3.4 Changing delegations

The board may change its Impact and Operational Expectation policies, thereby shifting the boundary between board and principal decision-making.

2.4 Monitoring Principal Performance

Systematic and rigorous monitoring of principal performance will be solely against the only expected principal job outputs: organisational accomplishment of board policies on Impacts and organisational operation within the boundaries established in board policies on Operational Expectations.

2.4.1 Purpose of Monitoring

Monitoring is simply to determine the degree to which board policies are being met. Information that does not do this will not be considered to be monitoring information.

2.4.2 Sources of information

The board will acquire monitoring information by one or more of three methods:

- a) By internal report, in which the principal discloses interpretations and compliance information to the board
- b) By external report, in which an external, disinterested third party selected by the board assesses compliance with board policies
- c) By direct board inspection, in which a designated member or members of the board assess compliance with the appropriate policy criteria.

2.4.3 Board Judgements

In every case, the board will judge (a) the reasonableness of the principal's interpretation and (b) whether data demonstrates accomplishment of the interpretation.

2.4.4 Reasonable Interpretation

The standard of compliance shall be any reasonable principal interpretation of the board policy being monitored. The board is the final arbiter of reasonableness but will always judge with a "reasonable person" test rather than with an interpretation favoured by board members or by the board as a whole.

2.4.5 Frequency of Policy Monitoring

All policies that instruct the principal will be monitored at a frequency and by a method chosen by the board. The board can monitor any policy at any time by any method, but will ordinarily depend on a routine schedule:

Policy	Method	Frequency
Treatment of Learners	Internal	Annually
Treatment of Staff	Internal	Annually
Financial Planning and Budgeting	Internal	Quarterly
Financial Condition and Activities	Internal	Quarterly
	External	Annually
Emergency principal Succession	Internal	Annually
Compensation and Benefits	Internal	Annually
	External	Every two years
Communication and Support	Direct Inspection	Annually

The board will also monitor and evaluate its own performance against strategic planning documents, as per Section 145 of the Education and Training Act 2020.

2.4.6 Catholic Character Monitoring

The board will monitor the principal's performance in maintaining and enhancing the Catholic character of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) in alignment with its special character agreement and the school's mission to "live, learn and love with Jesus, being the best we can be."

2.4.7 SPARK Values Integration

The board will assess the principal's effectiveness in integrating the school's SPARK values (Self-control, Positivity, Aroha, Respect, Kindness) into the school's curriculum, culture, and daily operations.

2.4.8 Kāhui Ako Collaboration

The board will monitor the principal's engagement and collaboration within the Northern Porirua Kāhui Ako|Community of Learning, ensuring that St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) is actively contributing to and benefiting from this partnership. This monitoring will include how the principal's engagement aligns with the board's obligations under Section 127(2)(d) of the Education and Training Act 2020.

2.4.9 Bicultural Competence

The board will evaluate the principal's efforts in fostering bicultural competence within the school community, with particular emphasis on respecting and integrating Te Tiriti o Waitangi principles and supporting the needs of Māori students (16% of the student population).

2.4.10 Holistic Education Framework

The board will assess the principal's implementation of a holistic education framework that develops autonomous learners while nurturing their spiritual, intellectual, social, and physical growth in line with Catholic education principles.

2.4.11 Child Protection Policies

The board will monitor the principal's role in implementing and maintaining the school's child protection policies, as required by the Children's Act 2014.

Legal References:

1. Section 127, Education and Training Act 2020
2. Regulation 8, Education (School Boards) Regulations 2020
3. Section 130, Education and Training Act 2020
4. Schedule 6, Education and Training Act 2020
5. Section 127(1)(d), Education and Training Act 2020
6. Section 145, Education and Training Act 2020
7. Section 127(2)(d), Education and Training Act 2020
8. Children's Act 2014

Operational Expectation Policies

3. Global Operational Expectation Policy

The principal shall not cause or allow any school practice, activity, decision, or circumstance that is either unlawful, imprudent, or in violation of their professional standards or commonly accepted business ethics and practices.

3.1 Expectations with students

The school board has an obligation to ensure the wellbeing of children in our care, so they belong, thrive, and achieve. We are committed to the prevention of child abuse and neglect and to the protection of all children. The safety and wellbeing of the child is our top priority. Advice will be sought through appropriate agencies in all cases of suspected or alleged abuse. In relation to students, the principal shall not cause or allow conditions, procedures, or decisions that are contrary to their rights, unsafe, untimely, undignified, or unnecessarily intrusive.

3.1.1 Child Safety

The principal will not fail to establish procedures that all employees and school contractors are aware of with respect to child safety that comply with legislation and recognised best practice so that any person in the school who believes that any child or young person who have been or are at risk of being harmed (whether physically, emotionally, or sexually) ill-treated, abused, neglected, or deprived must follow school procedures and report to a senior leader or the school guidance counsellor who may choose to report the matter local police or Oranga Tamariki. The principal shall ensure the school has a child protection policy as required by the Children's Act 2014.

3.1.2 Reducing distress and minimising restraint

The principal shall not fail to ensure that the Education (Physical Restraint) Rules 2023, and related guide on understanding distress and minimising restraint, are understood and followed by staff. This includes:

1. Ensuring all staff are trained in de-escalation techniques and positive behavior support strategies.
2. Implementing a clear reporting and documentation process for any instances of physical restraint.
3. Regularly reviewing and updating the school's policies and procedures related to physical restraint.
4. Providing ongoing support and guidance to staff in managing challenging behaviors without

resorting to physical restraint.

3.1.3 SPARK Values and Gospel Values

The principal shall not fail to promote and integrate the school's SPARK values (Self-control, Positivity, Aroha, Respect, Kindness) and gospel values, including manaakitanga and whanaungatanga, into all aspects of student life and learning.

3.1.4 Holistic Development

The principal shall not fail to foster an environment that supports the holistic development of students, including their spiritual, emotional, social, and cultural growth, in alignment with the school's Catholic character and mission.

3.1.5 Autonomous Learners

The principal shall not fail to implement strategies and programmes that develop autonomous learners within the holistic framework of St Theresa's School.

3.2 Expectations with staff

In relation to staff, the principal will not fail to observe current employment legislation and may not cause or allow conditions that are inconsistent with public sector expectations of a "good employer" or are unfair, undignified, disorganised, or unclear.

3.2.1 Good Faith

The principal will maintain a position of good faith in all interactions with staff. The principal shall not fail to:

- Ensure that employees are not discriminated against on other than clearly job-related, individual performance or qualifications.
- Ensure all employees their rights to personal dignity, safety and access to an approved and fair internal grievance process and
- Ensure that staff are aware of their responsibilities as employees of the school to their colleagues and to their employer.
- Provide Protected Disclosure procedures.

3.2.2 EEO

The principal shall not fail to develop and execute an EEO programme, that is available to all employees and report to the board on its implementation and compliance.

3.2.3 Remuneration and Benefits

The principal should not fail to have employment agreement for all employees. If a position is covered by a collective agreement the provisions that apply to that position as described in the collective agreement must be applied. For positions for which there is not a collective agreement available that an individual agreement is in place.

3.2.4 Engagement of Consultants, Contractors and volunteers

The principal may not enter into any grant or contract arrangements that fail to emphasise primarily the meeting of Impacts and, secondarily, the avoidance of unacceptable means.

3.2.5 Professional Development

The principal shall not fail to provide opportunities for staff professional development that aligns with the school's Catholic character, SPARK values, and commitment to developing autonomous learners.

3.3 Financial Conditions & Activity

In relation to the actual, ongoing financial conditions and activities, the principal shall not cause or allow the development of financial jeopardy or material deviation of actual expenditures from board priorities established in Impact Policies. The principal shall ensure compliance with the Crown Entities Act 2004 and the Education and Training Act 2020 regarding financial management, including:

1. Preparing and submitting annual financial statements in accordance with generally accepted accounting practice.
2. Maintaining proper accounting records.
3. Ensuring efficient use of resources and responsible financial management.
4. Reporting regularly to the board on the school's financial performance.

3.3.1 Financial Planning/Budgeting

Budgeting shall not fail to reflect the board's Impact policies, risk financial jeopardy nor fail to show a generally acceptable level of foresight. Thus, the budget should not neglect to:

- Reflect the impacts sought by the board.
- Reflect the priorities as established by the board.
- Comply with the board's requirement of a balanced budget.
- Ensure adequate working capital.
- Demonstrate an appropriate degree of conservatism in all estimates

3.3.2 Financial Condition

The financial viability of the school must be protected at all times. Therefore, the principal shall not:

- a. Incur unauthorised debt.
- b. Violate generally accepted accounting practices or principles.
- c. Use tagged funds for purposes other than those approved.
- d. Spend more funds than have been allocated in the fiscal year.
- e. Fail to ensure all money owed to the school is collected in a timely manner.
- f. Fail to make timely payment to staff and other creditors
- g. Sell or purchase unauthorised property.
- h. Spend on single items beyond a board-established limit.
- i. Fail to ensure that all relevant government returns are completed on time.
- j. Fail to ensure that no one person has complete authority over the school's financial transactions.
- k. Make any purchase:
 1. Of over \$5000 without having obtained comparative prices and quality.
 2. Of over \$10,000 without an adequate review on ongoing costs, value and reliability

3.3.3 Impact Focus of Grants or Contracts

The principal may not enter into any grant or contract arrangements that fail to emphasise primarily the meeting of Impacts and, secondarily, the avoidance of unacceptable means.

3.4 Asset Protection

The principal shall not cause or allow school assets to be unprotected, inadequately maintained, or unnecessarily risked. The principal shall ensure compliance with the Crown Entities Act 2004 regarding asset management, including:

1. Maintaining an up-to-date asset register.
2. Implementing appropriate asset management strategies.
3. Ensuring proper care, maintenance, and security of school assets.
4. Reporting regularly to the board on the state of the school's assets.

Therefore, the Principal may not:

- a) Fail to insure assets.
- b) Allow unauthorised personnel to handle funds or school property.
- c) Subject plant and equipment to improper wear and tear or insufficient maintenance or inappropriate use.
- d) Fail to ensure the implementation of the 10-year property maintenance plan
- e) Fail to protect intellectual property, information and files from loss or significant damage or unauthorised access or duplication.
- f) Receive, process or disburse funds under controls that are insufficient to meet the board-appointed auditor's standards.
- g) Invest or hold operating capital in insecure accounts, or in non-interest bearing accounts except where necessary to facilitate ease in operational transactions.

3.5 Communication and Support to the Board

The principal shall not cause or allow the board to be uninformed or unsupported in its work.

3.6 Emergency Principal Succession

To protect the board from sudden loss of Principal services, the principal shall not permit there to be fewer than two other senior managers sufficiently familiar with board and Principal issues and processes to enable either to take over with reasonable proficiency as an interim successor.

3.7 Health & Safety

Students and staff shall have a safe physical and emotional learning environment. The board recognises that everyone is responsible for Health & Safety and that the board, in its role as the PCBU (Person Conducting a Business or Undertaking), has the primary responsibility for the health, safety and wellbeing of workers but, that the board expects the principal and staff to design and implement a Health and Safety system that protects all employees, students, volunteers, contractors and visitors to the school. The principal will provide the board with regular reports to give the board assurance that the school is a safe physically and emotionally place for all students and staff.

The principal shall ensure compliance with the Health and Safety at Work Act 2015, including:

1. Identifying and managing workplace risks and hazards.
2. Providing appropriate training and resources for staff to carry out their work safely.
3. Ensuring proper procedures are in place for reporting and addressing health and safety concerns.
4. Regularly reviewing and updating the school's health and safety policies and procedures.

3.7.1 Workers Participation

The Health & Safety System will ensure workers are regularly made aware of opportunities to participate in improving health and safety including through health and safety representatives and the health and safety committee.

The principal will also ensure workers can raise any health and safety concerns directly with them.

3.7.2 Managing Risk

The Health & Safety System will include clearly documented procedures for identifying and reporting hazards and risk and systems for managing those risks that may include mitigation or rectification.

3.7.3 Property and Equipment

The principal must have systems that ensure that all property and equipment are well-maintained and are in safe condition to use.

3.7.4 Emergency Plans including evacuations

The Health and Safety System will include plans for responding to emergencies affecting the school, including weather related events, natural disasters and other threats to health and life. The principal is delegated the authority to deal with all aspects of such events including decisions to close the school if it is deemed unsafe to remain open.

3.7.5 Health and Wellbeing

The principal will engage closely with staff and students to support a proactive approach to health and wellbeing with specific health and well-being programmes.

3.7.6 Induction, training and information

The principal will not fail to ensure that a programme of induction is provided for all new employees and that staff receive professional development in health and safety that will strengthen the capability of staff to maintain a safe and happy work environment including how to keep themselves as safe as possible.

3.7.7 EOTC provisions

The principal will not fail to ensure that the Health & Safety System will include specific systems for ensuring that all EOTC events including sports events are safe for all participants and appropriately supervised.

3.8 Concerns and complaints

The principal shall not fail to ensure robust procedures to ensure complaints, concerns and incidents are attended to promptly, fairly, respectfully and professionally, and seek to bring effective resolution to all parties concerned.

3.8.1 The principal shall not fail to ensure:

- a) processes involved observe principles of natural justice;
- b) the process for complaints or grievances is clearly communicated and posted on the school website;
- c) Staff are empowered to successfully address concerns and complaints, including de-escalating without minimising concerns;
- d) advice is given to members of the learning community on how to formulate concerns and complaints;
- e) a complainant has previously followed the school's concerns and complaints procedure before a complaint is escalated to board level;

f) advise complainants that, if the principal's action or inaction in relation to a concern or complaint is unfair, unreasonable, or contrary to the facts, board policy or the law, they may make a complaint in those terms to the board.

3.9 Catholic Character

The principal shall not fail to:

- a) Maintain and enhance the Catholic character of St Theresa's School in all aspects of school life.
- b) Ensure that the school's Catholic values are integrated into the curriculum and daily practices.
- c) Foster a strong relationship with the local parish and Catholic community.
- d) Provide opportunities for staff and students to participate in Catholic religious education and sacramental programmes.
- e) Ensure that the school environment reflects its Catholic identity through appropriate symbols and practices.

3.10 Community Engagement

The principal shall not fail to:

- a) Foster strong relationships with the local community, including Māori and Samoan communities.
- b) Actively participate in and contribute to the Northern Porirua Kāhui Ako Community of Learning.
- c) Develop and maintain partnerships with local businesses, organisations, and cultural groups that enhance learning opportunities for students.
- d) Regularly communicate with parents and caregivers about school activities, student progress, and opportunities for involvement.
- e) Ensure that the school's communication and engagement strategies are inclusive and accessible to all members of the school community.

Legal References:

1. Children's Act 2014
2. Education (Physical Restraint) Rules 2023
3. Health and Safety at Work Act 2015
4. Crown Entities Act 2004
5. Education and Training Act 2020
6. Board Assurance Statement guidelines

Governance Culture Policies

4. Global Governance Culture Policy

The purpose of the board, on behalf of the Crown and community, is to see to it that the school (a) achieves its desired results for its students (as described in its Impact policies) within the resourcing available to it, (b) avoids unacceptable actions and situations (as prohibited in board Operational Expectation policies) while fulfilling its commitment to Te Tiriti o Waitangi.

4.1 Governing Style

The board of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) will govern with an emphasis on:

1. Strategic leadership rather than administrative detail
2. Clear distinction between board and principal roles
3. Future-focused and proactive decision making
4. Encouragement of diversity in viewpoints
5. Collective rather than individual decisions
6. Maintaining strong relationships with the school community and parish
7. Giving effect to Te Tiriti o Waitangi[1]

4.1.1 Group Responsibility

The board will cultivate a sense of group responsibility. All members of the board have equal standing, voice, vote and accountability. The board, not the staff, will be responsible for excellence in governing. The board will be the initiator of policy, not merely a reactor to staff initiatives. Although individual board members may have expert knowledge on matters being discussed, the decision rests with the whole board.

4.1.2 Direction through Policy

The board will direct, control, and inspire the school staff through the careful establishment of broad written policies reflecting the board's values and perspectives, including:

- Impact policies
- Operational Expectations policies
- Governance Culture policies
- Board-Management Relationship policies

4.1.3 Board Discipline

Board members will adhere to the government-mandated code of conduct for school board members, as outlined in sections 166-169 of the Education and Training Act 2020[2]. The board will enforce upon itself whatever discipline is needed to govern with excellence, including attendance, preparation for meetings, policymaking principles, respect of roles, and ensuring the continuance of governance capability.

4.1.4 Board Continuity & Development

The board will ensure continual development, including:

- Thorough induction of new board members
- Regular professional development opportunities
- Succession planning to maintain board effectiveness
- Periodic self-evaluation and improvement of governance processes

4.1.5 Board Self-monitoring

The board will regularly monitor its own performance, comparing board activity and discipline to policies in the Governance Culture and Board-Management Relationship categories.

4.2 Board's Role

The board's role is to provide leadership by reflecting the agreed aspirations and expectations of the school community, the Crown, and the Catholic character of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) in board policy. The board is accountable to the community and the Crown on these key roles and will regularly report on progress and compliance.

4.2.1 Connection to Owners

The board will:

1. Gain an understanding of Crown expectations as expressed in legislation
2. Regularly engage with the school community, including parents, whānau, and parish members
3. Consult with local iwi and the Māori community to honour Te Tiriti o Waitangi
4. Incorporate community values and aspirations into board policy
5. Consult with the school's Māori community on policies and plans for improving the progress and achievement of Māori students[3]

4.2.2 Monitoring & Assurance

The board will monitor the effect of its policies through:

1. Principal reports
2. Third-party monitoring
3. Direct inspection, where warranted

This process will ensure successful school performance on Impacts and Operational Expectations.

4.2.3 Board Work Plan

To fulfil its role, the board will follow an annual work plan that:

1. Re-explores Impact policies annually
2. Continually improves board performance through education and enriched input
3. Reviews other policies as appropriate
4. Aligns with the school's strategic plan and annual implementation plan
5. Incorporates consultation with the school community and key stakeholders

4.3 Principal Monitoring

Principal monitoring will be a regular agenda item at board meetings, including:

1. Review of reports received since the previous meeting
2. Planning for direct inspection monitoring
3. Arrangements for third-party monitoring

4.4 Board Meetings

Board meetings will follow the requirements of:

1. The Education (School Boards) Regulations 2020[6]
2. Part 7 of the Local Government Official Information and Meetings Act 1987[7]

The board may use formal meeting procedures or consensus decision-making, depending on the nature and importance of the issue being discussed.

Meeting minutes will be made available to the public, as required by section 51 of the Local Government Official Information and Meetings Act 1987[4].

4.5 Presiding Member's Role

The presiding member (PM) chairs the board meetings and ensures the integrity of the board's process.

4.5.1 Presiding Member's Role

The PM's role includes:

1. Overseeing the work of the board
2. Ensuring meetings focus on issues that belong to the board
3. Facilitating fair, open, and thorough deliberations
4. Maintaining order and focus in meetings

4.5.2 Presiding Member's Authority

The PM has the authority to make decisions under the board policies on Governance Culture and Board-Management Relationship, except for:

1. The employment or termination of the principal
2. Areas where the board specifically delegates portions of this authority to others

4.6 Board Secretary

The board secretary ensures the integrity of the board's documents.

4.6.1 Board Secretary's Role

The board secretary's responsibilities include:

1. Maintaining accurate meeting minutes
2. Organising and maintaining a central collection of current policies
3. Managing board correspondence
4. Keeping up-to-date board membership records
5. Maintaining an information portfolio for each board member

4.7 Board Committee Principles

Board committees will be used sparingly and will never interfere with delegation from the board to the principal.

4.7.1 Board Committee Role

Board committees will assist the board by preparing policy alternatives and implications for board deliberation.

4.7.2 Board Committee Scope

Board committees may not speak or act for the board except when formally given such authority for specific and time-limited purposes.

4.7.3 Board Committees Limit on Authority

Board committees cannot exercise authority over staff. The principal works for the full board and will not be required to obtain approval from a board committee before an executive action.

4.8 Cost of Governance

The board will invest in its governance capacity to ensure effective leadership.

4.8.1 Resourcing the Board

The board will ensure sufficient resources for:

1. Training and professional development for board members
2. Outside monitoring assistance
3. Community outreach and consultation

4.8.2 Board Costs

The board will establish its Cost of Governance budget annually, including allocations for:

1. Training and conference attendance
2. Audit and third-party monitoring
3. Surveys, focus groups, and community engagement activities

4.9 Prohibition of Mobile Phone Use

The board is obligated to prohibit students from using or accessing mobile phones during the school day, as per the Education (School Boards) Amendment Regulations 2023[5].

This governance framework will guide the board of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) in fulfilling its responsibilities to the school community, upholding the school's Catholic character, and ensuring the best possible outcomes for all students.

Legal References:

- [1] Section 127(1)(d) of the Education and Training Act 2020
- [2] Sections 166-169 of the Education and Training Act 2020
- [3] Section 127(1)(d) of the Education and Training Act 2020
- [4] Section 51 of the Local Government Official Information and Meetings Act 1987
- [5] Education (School Boards) Amendment Regulations 2023
- [6] Education (School Boards) Regulations 2020
- [7] Part 7 of the Local Government Official Information and Meetings Act 1987
- [8] Section 127 of the Education and Training Act 2020

Conclusion

This comprehensive policy document provides a robust framework for the governance of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton). It reflects the school's unique character as a Catholic state-integrated primary school and incorporates the principles of effective governance, strategic leadership, and accountability.

The policies outlined in this document are designed to:

1. Guide the board in its decision-making processes
2. Clarify the roles and responsibilities of the board and the principal
3. Ensure the school operates within legal and ethical boundaries
4. Promote the achievement of desired outcomes for students

5. Uphold the school's Catholic character and SPARK values
6. Foster strong relationships with the school community, parish, and wider educational network

By adhering to these policies, the board of St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) will be well-equipped to provide effective governance, support the school's mission, and ensure the best possible educational outcomes for all students. This document should be viewed as a living document, subject to regular review and refinement to meet the evolving needs of the school and its community.

The success of these policies relies on the commitment of all board members to uphold their responsibilities, maintain open communication, and continually strive for excellence in governance. Through this commitment, St Theresa's School (Plimmerton) can continue to thrive as a place where students live, learn, and love with Jesus, being the best they can be.